AI Agent Skills and MCP: Building the Right AI Agent Pattern

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Chapter 4: Combining Agent Skills and MCP

Building the Final Hybrid Workflow

Let the agent record High risks in the team's register, following rules about when and how to write

In the previous video the agent read Orbit Labs' systems and judged what it found using the team's rubric. The last step is action. In this video you add rules for writing to the shared risk register, then run the complete workflow end to end: one request, live data, consistent judgment, and a clean register.

Before you start

Your workspace should be at the end state of video 04_01: the `orbit` server connected, and the Skill in `.claude/skills` with the Gather the information section. If you're not sure, run this from the folder that contains `orbit-launch` and `solutions`:

```
node solutions/catch-up.mjs 04_01
```

Step 1: Start a new week

Simulate a new week with a fresh incident. From a terminal in `orbit-backend`, run:

```
npm run reset
npm run demo:new-ticket
```

The risk register is empty, and the support desk now has TCK-2031: six beta customers can't sign in through SSO.

Step 2: Add the write step to the Skill

Open `.claude/skills/launch-risk-review/SKILL.md` and make two additions.

First, add a seventh step at the end of the Process list, after step 6:

```
7. **Record High risks.** If the `orbit` server is available, record every
High risk in the launch risk register (see below).
```

Second, add this section after the Process list and before `## Rules`:

```
## Record High risks

The risk register is shared with the whole team, so keep it clean.

1. Call `list_risk_items` first. Skip any risk that's already recorded
with the same underlying problem.
2. For each new High risk, call `create_risk_item` with the same title,
evidence IDs, next action, and suggested owner you used in the report.
3. Don't record Medium or Low risks unless the user asks.
4. Finish the report with a "Recorded in risk register" line listing the
new item IDs, or "No new items".
```

Each rule answers a question the MCP-only agent in video 03_04 had to guess at:

- **What qualifies?** Only High risks. Medium and Low stay in the report.
- **Is it already there?** Read the register before writing, and skip anything already recorded.
- **What goes in it?** The same title, evidence, next action, and owner as the report, so the two always agree.
- **What did you do?** Say which items were created, so a person can see every change the agent made.

Step 3: Run the review

Start a new Claude Code session in `orbit-launch` and send:

```
Do this week’s launch review.
```

Approve the read-only `orbit` tool calls as they appear.

Step 4: Approve the register writes

After the report, the agent calls `list_risk_items`, finds the register empty, and then asks to call `create_risk_item` for each High risk. Approve those calls.

Look for:

- **Overall status: Off track.**
- **Four High risks:** the PayGate slip (T-104), the unowned pen test booking (T-117), the duplicate charges (TCK-1987, TCK-1992, TCK-2003, TCK-2010), and the SSO outage (TCK-2031).
- **Four new register items,** RISK-001 to RISK-004. The order may differ.
- **A Recorded in risk register line** at the end of the report, listing the new IDs.
- **No Medium or Low risks in the register.** The docs risk and the Low items appear in the report only.

The SSO outage is rated High even though the ticket is brand new. The rubric’s widespread blocker rule says any open P1 affecting more than three customers is High, regardless of age. You wrote that rule in Chapter 2, before this situation existed. A good rubric covers cases you haven’t seen yet.

Step 5: Run it again

Start a new session, or type `/clear`, and send the same request again:

```
Do this week's launch review.
```

The report should match the first run and end with **Recorded in risk register: No new items**. The agent read the register first and found every High risk already there.

Step 6: Check the register

Send:

```
List everything in the launch risk register.
```

You should see exactly four items, one per High risk, with no duplicates. Compare that with the register at the end of video 03_04.

The complete workflow

The request is still one line. Here's where each part of the work comes from:

- **Recognize a launch review request:** the Skill's description.
- **Decide what data to fetch:** the Skill's Gather the information section.
- **Fetch milestones, tasks, and tickets:** the MCP tools.
- **Judge severity and filter noise:** the Skill's rubric.
- **Write the report:** the Skill's template.
- **Check the register and record High risks:** the Skill's rules, carried out with MCP tools.

Patterns worth reusing

- **Read first, write last.** Gather and judge before taking any action.
- **Check before you create.** Reading existing items first makes the workflow safe to run more than once.
- **Write only what qualifies.** Clear criteria keep shared systems clean.
- **Report every change.** Listing created items gives people a simple audit trail.
- **Keep two layers of control.** The Skill governs what the agent tries to do. Tool permissions govern what it's allowed to do. You still approved every write.

To replay the demo

From a terminal in `orbit-backend`, run `npm run reset` and then `npm run demo:new-ticket`.

If you get stuck

From the folder that contains `orbit-launch` and `solutions`, run:

```
node solutions/catch-up.mjs 04_02
```

This writes the final version of `SKILL.md`. Start a new Claude Code session afterward.